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CURRENT POSITIONS

2025	IMF, Economist Research Department, Open Economy Division
2022-2025	IMF, Economist Program Research Department, Open Economy Division (2024-present) Asia and Pacific Department, Pacific Island Division (2022-2024) Real and external sector economist for the Solomon Islands (2023 AIV) Real, external, and financial sector economist for Tuvalu (2023 AIV)

EDUCATION

2022	Ph.D. in Economics, University of Rochester
2018	M.A. in Economics, University of Rochester
2015	M.A. in Economics, Universidad Torcuato Di Tella, Argentina
2014	B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad del Salvador, Argentina, <i>summa cum laude</i>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

International Trade, Finance, and Macroeconomics.

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS

2023	Visiting Scholar, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis
2021	Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis Junior Scholar Conference
2021	Dissertation Intern, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis
2021	Americas Center Graduate Dissertation Intern, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta
2021-2022	Dean's Post-Field Research Dissertation Completion Fellowship, University of Rochester
2021	Tapan Mitra Prize, Best 5th-Year Paper, Empirical Economics, University of Rochester
2016-2021	Economics Department Ph.D. Fellowship and Scholarship, University of Rochester

2020-2021	Ronald Jones Scholar, University of Rochester
2021	Human Studies Fellowship, Institute for Human Studies
2020	River Campus Data Grant, University of Rochester
2020	Human Studies Fellowship, Institute for Human Studies
2019-2020	The Wallis Institute of Political Economy Fellowship, University of Rochester
2019	The Conibear Prize for the Best 3rd Year Paper, University of Rochester
2018	Summer Research Grant, University of Rochester
2014	Best GPA in the B.Sc. in Economics, Universidad del Salvador, Argentina
2014	Best Undergraduate Thesis, Universidad del Salvador, Argentina

RESEARCH

WORKING PAPERS

["INTERNATIONAL TRADE, VOLATILITY, AND INCOME DIFFERENCES"](#) - Under review -

Abstract. This paper presents a unified explanation for two puzzles in trade and development: developing countries' unexplained high export costs and the negative correlation between firm-level volatility and exports. I propose a novel general equilibrium model featuring heterogeneous firms, variable demand elasticity, and exporter dynamics. Under this framework, downturn profit losses outweigh boom gains, reversing the "Oi-Hartman-Abel" effect typically found in heterogeneous firm models. Consequently, firm-level volatility discourages exporting and investment, significantly reducing income and aggregate exports. Quantitatively, the model explains a substantial share of the puzzling cross-country export cost differences and the observed negative relationship between firm-level sales volatility with both income and exports.

["WHEN TRADE COMPRESSES: THE IMPACT OF LIBERALIZATION ON WAGE INEQUALITY"](#) , with V. Hernandez and N. Kozeniauskas. Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland, Working Paper No. 26-01

Abstract. We study the effects of trade liberalization on the full wage distribution, exploiting Spain's 1993 entry into the European Single Market. Using employer-employee data, we identify the causal effects of trade across the entire wage distribution, using a novel shift-share instrument embedded in an unconditional quantile regression. We find that the liberalization reduced wage inequality, leading to wage compression through earnings gains at the bottom of the distribution and wage losses at the top. We trace this compression to two asymmetric channels: import competition disproportionately harmed high earners, while export opportunities benefited low earners. The key mechanism is an import-driven "skill-downgrading." A multi-region multi-sector model shows that the key insight for understanding these empirical results is that trade's distributional effects depend on the skill intensity of a country's tradable sector, and Spain's was relatively low-skill intensive back then

["MACRO ASYMMETRIC TRADE COSTS AND CURRENT ACCOUNT DYNAMICS"](#), with B. Shin

Abstract. We develop a model-consistent methodology to measure and decompose macro-level trade costs into common and asymmetric components. These two components yield fundamentally different macroeconomic consequences. Common shocks reduce trade openness, they remain neutral for external balances. Asymmetric shocks generate fluctuations in the trade balance, the current account, and the real exchange rate by distorting the effective price of international lending and shifting absorption forward. We validate these measures using quasi-experimental variation from trade policy events. We find that tariff increases predominantly generate common cost movements, providing a structural explanation for why protectionism often fails to improve the trade balance.

"TRADE-BASED QUASI-FISCAL DEVALUATIONS", with S. Gomez and M. MacMullen

Abstract. We study trade-based (quasi-)fiscal devaluations by exploiting changes in China's system of partial value-added tax rebates on exports (VATRX), which act as time-varying export subsidies. Using highly disaggregated VATRX and customs data, we estimate the dynamic effects of rebate changes on export quantities and prices. Permanent changes in VATRX generate a dynamic quantity response—with trade elasticities rising from 1.2 on impact to 17 in the long run—and complete pass-through to export prices. We embed these micro estimates into a two-country New Keynesian model with delayed substitution in trade flows. Applying the model to the 2008 global financial crisis, we find that China's increase in VATRX boosted exports and GDP by 17 and 1 percentage points, respectively. Trade policy thus offers an effective fiscal-devaluation instrument.

"REAL EXCHANGE RATE UNCERTAINTY MATTERS"

Abstract: I introduce a novel, forward-looking, and model-consistent measure of real exchange rate uncertainty (RERU) to study its effects on international trade. I demonstrate that a rising RERU triggers a precautionary response from exporters: export intensity and entry into new markets decline, while export prices and exit rates increase. The empirical results show that these microeconomic adjustments are primarily driven by exporters facing higher interest rates. I develop a sunk-cost trade model with heterogeneous firms and firm-specific default risk that is consistent with these findings. Increased RERU exposes exporters to greater financial vulnerability, which they hedge against by increasing markups or exiting the export market, as documented in my findings. Quantitatively, the model predicts that a standard deviation increase in RERU reduces total exports by 6%.

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

"FIGHTING TARIFFS WITH EXPORT VALUE ADDED TAX REBATES?", with A. Khederlarian and M. MacMullen

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2026: ASSA, SED*

2025: Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, EEA, SEA, 10th IMF-World Bank-WTO Trade Conference

2024: AEA Meetings, Center for Inclusive Trade Policy (CITP), NASM, SED, EARIE, EEA, ESEM, Midwest International Trade & Theory Meetings, Winter SED, SEA

2023: AEA Meetings, Midwest International Meetings, Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, ETSG, SEA, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, UTDT Annual Economics Conference

2022: Society of Economic Dynamics, RIDGE Forum: International Macro, RIDGE Forum: Growth and Development in Macroeconomics, University of Wisconsin–Madison, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Federal Reserve Board of Governors, Pontifical Catholic University of Rio de Janeiro, University ORT, Universidad del Rosario, EAFIT

2021: Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis Junior Scholar Conference, Brown Bag Seminar, Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, Ph.D. Interns Workshop, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, LACEA-RIDGE Job Market Showcase

2020: GISPE workshop, Centro de Estudios Macroeconomicos Argentina (CEMA University), KERIC Conference, Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile.

* scheduled presentation.

REFEREEING

Review of Economic Studies; Journal of International Economics; International Economic Review; IMF Economic Review; Journal of Money, Credit and Banking.

POLICY CONTRIBUTIONS

2025 EXTERNAL SECTOR REPORT. Chapter 1

2024 EXTERNAL SECTOR REPORT. Chapter 2

Solomon Islands. 2024 Article IV Staff Report. IMF Country Report No. 25/49 International Monetary Fund.

Solomon Islands. 2023 Article IV Staff Report. IMF Country Report No. 23/162 International Monetary Fund.

"Solomon Islands Country Economic Memorandum: Unlocking New Sources of Economic Growth", World Bank. (Chapter 4: Unlocking New Sectoral Sources of Economic Growth.)

Tuvalu. 2023 Article IV Staff Report. IMF Country Report No. 23/267 International Monetary Fund.

Migration and Development in Pacific Islands Countries, joint with Seruwaia Cagliaba and Zhang Ruifeng. *Presented at the IMF Pacific Islands High-Level Conference in February 2024*

PRESS

"TUVALU NEEDS TO BUILD RESILIENCE AMID THREAT FROM RISING SEAS." IMF BLOG. JULY 2023

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

INSTRUCTOR

2020 *Principles of Economics (Undergraduate)*, University of Rochester. Summer.

TEACHING ASSISTANT

2018-2020 *Macroeconomics (Graduate)*, University of Rochester, Fall semester
Instructor: Prof. George Alessandria

2019 *Money, Credit and Banking (Undergraduate)*, University of Rochester, Spring semester
Instructor: Prof. Narayana Kocherlakota

2018 *Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)*, University of Rochester, Spring semester
Instructor: Prof. Dan Lu

2018-2019 *Pricing Policies (Graduate)*, Simon Business School, University of Rochester, Fall semester
Instructor: Prof. Greg Shaffer

2015-2016 *Introduction to Statistic and Probability (Undergraduate)*, Torcuato Di Tella University
Instructor: Prof. Andrea Rotnitzky

2015-2016 *Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)*, Torcuato Di Tella University, Fall semester
Instructor: Prof. Emilio Espino

2014 *Microeconomics 1 (Undergraduate)*, Torcuato Di Tella University, Fall semester
Instructor: Prof. Hernán Ruffo

OTHERS

LANGUAGE: ENGLISH (FLUENT), SPANISH (NATIVE)

SOFTWARE: JULIA, STATA, MATLAB, PYTHON, $\text{\LaTeX}$